

The Historical Archaeologist

Nerve +2 | Notice +4 | Rapport +1 | Reason +3 | Vigor +0

Someone anonymously sent you a box containing photographs, floor plans, correspondence, and property records from Mourning Bluff Manor that have never appeared in any archive. The documents establish that a previously unknown inheritor now owns the estate. The inheritor asked you to investigate the property and prove that its infamous hauntings are tricks, misunderstandings, or stories grown wild with age.

The notebook contains your written observations, measurements, sketches, rubbings, and loose research materials. You may add to it, consult it, show it to others, remove pages, or use it in any other way a physical notebook reasonably permits.

The Relative

Nerve +4 | Notice +2 | Rapport +3 | Reason +0 | Vigor +1

Someone you love became obsessed with Mourning Bluff Manor and disappeared while trying to reach it. The authorities found no evidence that they ever entered the estate. When you learned that the new inheritor was allowing a private investigation, you demanded a place in the group. You are not interested in ghost stories. You want to discover what happened and, against all reason, still hope to bring them home.

You carry a slightly faded Polaroid of the missing person laughing in a sunlit park. They are caught mid-laugh with their head turned slightly away from the camera, one hand raised as if they had just tried to hide their face. Green grass, a picnic table, and several distant trees fill the background. It was taken before they became obsessed with Mourning Bluff Manor.

The Fraudulent Medium

Nerve +2 | Notice +3 | Rapport +4 | Reason +1 | Vigor +0

You make a living pretending to speak with the dead. Outwardly, you perform with absolute confidence; privately, you believe you are a fraud who has mistaken instinct and coincidence for something more. But once, and only once, you had a vision you could not explain. You saw Mourning Bluff Manor, including details you later confirmed had never been made public. You have come to the house grasping for proof that the vision was real and that perhaps you have not been pretending all this time.

You carry a small brass séance bell with a dark wooden handle worn smooth by years of use. Bells like this are traditionally placed on séance tables so spirits can announce their presence or answer questions by ringing without a living hand touching them.

The Paramedic

Nerve +3 | Notice +1 | Rapport +0 | Reason +2 | Vigor +4

One of the people entering Mourning Bluff Manor is your friend, and you insisted on coming because someone needed to take the ordinary dangers seriously. You do not necessarily believe the house is haunted, but you do believe in rotten floorboards, rusty nails, asbestos, unstable stairs, and being hours away from medical help. Once people start getting hurt, it does not matter who brought you here. You are the person with the training to keep them alive.

You carry a compact red trauma bag made from heavy waterproof fabric, with reflective strips, reinforced handles, and several zippered compartments. Inside are gloves, gauze, bandages, medical tape, antiseptic, trauma shears, a tourniquet, instant cold packs, a folding splint, a stethoscope, a penlight, and a small supply of common emergency medications.

The Psychic Researcher

Nerve +3 | Notice +2 | Rapport +1 | Reason +4 | Vigor +0

You study clairvoyance, precognition, and anomalous perception through controlled experiments. You want psychic phenomena to be real, but every case you have examined has collapsed under scrutiny, produced inconclusive results, or could not be repeated. When invited to join the investigation of Mourning Bluff Manor, you accepted the opportunity to observe a reputed haunting firsthand. You are not there to communicate with the dead or explain away what happens. You want to determine whether genuine psychic phenomena can be measured, repeated, and quantified.

You carry a rugged black data logger about the size of a paperback book, with rubberized corners, a small green display, several blinking indicator lights, and a bundle of wired sensors clipped to its case. Its internal clock continuously records and timestamps temperature, air pressure, vibration, sound, and electromagnetic activity.

The Psychiatrist

Nerve +1 | Notice +0 | Rapport +4 | Reason +3 | Vigor +2

You were the attending psychiatrist responsible for the last known person to enter Mourning Bluff Manor. They returned alive but profoundly disturbed, unable to separate memories from hallucinations or describe the house without contradicting themselves. Nothing you tried restored them, and their condition has continued to deteriorate. You have entered the manor to understand what happened to your patient and determine whether the source was trauma, delusion, or something you were never trained to diagnose.

You carry a palm-sized microcassette recorder with a scratched plastic casing, a built-in speaker, and large mechanical buttons that click loudly when pressed. The cassette inside contains recordings of your final sessions with the patient, and the carrying case holds several blank tapes and spare batteries.

The Detective

Nerve +1 | Notice +4 | Rapport +0 | Reason +3 | Vigor +2

You spent years investigating disappearances connected to Mourning Bluff Manor. What began as an overlooked pattern became the only case that mattered to you. Your superiors called your conclusions speculative, then reckless, and finally removed you from the investigation. You are officially on administrative leave and have been ordered to stay away. You have entered the manor anyway, determined to find the evidence that proves the disappearances are connected, and that you were right to keep digging.

You carry a heavy black metal flashlight with a wide glass lens, a ridged grip, and a sliding switch worn smooth by years of use. Its casing is scratched and dented, but its strong white beam still cuts cleanly through the dark.

The Priest

Nerve +0 | Notice +2 | Rapport +4 | Reason +3 | Vigor +1

You have spent years listening to people describe grief, guilt, visions, and experiences they believe were supernatural. Most needed compassion more than an exorcism. When the new inheritor sought help concerning Mourning Bluff Manor, you agreed to enter, investigate its stories, and determine whether the house requires a blessing, a more serious spiritual intervention, or no religious response at all. You are here to protect the living before passing judgment on the dead.

You carry a small silver crucifix on a black cord, its edges worn smooth from years of being held during prayer.

The Dreamer

Nerve +3 | Notice +4 | Rapport +2 | Reason +1 | Vigor +0

You have walked the rooms of Mourning Bluff Manor in your dreams for months, recognizing people you have never met and always waking before you reach the same locked door. Recently the dreams changed: five visitors entered the house together, and one of them was you. When you discovered that an investigation was actually being organized, you contacted the others because you already knew where and when they would meet.

You carry a roughly drawn map made by an inexperienced hand with colored markers on several sheets of paper taped together. The lines are uneven, labels crowd one another, and the whole thing has been folded and unfolded until the paper has softened and the tape has begun to split along the creases.

The Inheritor

Nerve +3 | Notice +1 | Rapport +2 | Reason +0 | Vigor +4

You are an ordinary person who has unexpectedly become the legal owner of Mourning Bluff Manor. You have always been more comfortable with training, competition, and physical problems than old documents or ghost stories, and you want nothing to do with the house. Your mother was obsessed with it, but she died when you were very young. After her death, your father destroyed everything she had collected about the manor and refused to speak of it again. Now the estate has passed to you, bringing her obsession back into your life. You have come to understand why she cared about this place and decide what must be done with it.

You carry a long iron skeleton key with an oval bow, a narrow shaft, and uneven teeth polished bright from use. A faded paper tag tied to it reads 669 WIDOW'S WALK, MOURNING BLUFF, MAINE.